

Do's and Don'ts of Interviewing

The following list of tips offers common sense guidelines for the interview and can also be used in other parts of your job search.

Do's

1. DO arrive 10-15 minutes early to use the restroom, find offices, allow for unexpected traffic problems, and to RELAX! It may be wise to visit the job site prior to the interview to determine location and travel time.
2. DO get a good night's sleep the night before so you will be mentally alert.
3. DO express enthusiasm. Smile and offer a firm handshake upon meeting the interviewer or other staff; speak clearly and directly, and vary the tone of your voice.
4. DO know and correctly pronounce the names of people you meet (or are speaking with over the phone).
5. DO use "please" and "thank you" when appropriate.
6. DO answer interview questions completely.
7. DO sit up straight and maintain good eye contact.
8. DO dress appropriately and appear well-groomed.
9. DO practice answering difficult, illegal or "too personal" questions.
10. DO come alone. Don't bring a relative or friend.
11. DO get information about the company/organization ahead of time.
12. DO sell your qualifications rather than your need for the job.
13. DO treat administrative assistants and receptionists politely
14. DO listen carefully to the interviewer.
15. DO express your interest in the job.

Don'ts

1. DON'T ask questions about pay and benefits.
2. DON'T act as if you have to have this job no matter what.
3. DON'T interrupt. If you have questions or need clarification, wait for a logical break in the conversation before speaking.
4. DON'T bring up personal matters (personal problems, financial matters, health issues). Focus on your qualifications for the job.
5. DON'T criticize former employers or co-workers.
6. DON'T give petty excuses such as: The work was too hard; The people I worked with were not nice.
7. DON'T chew gum, smoke, play with your hair, or constantly adjust your clothes.

8. DON'T read any papers, place anything on the interviewer's desk, or handle any item on the interviewer's desk.
9. DON'T bring bulky items to the interview. A small notebook and pen for note taking is acceptable.
10. DON'T be shy. Sell yourself. Be confident. The interview is about you and you are the expert.